

# Steal to Chill

Fans are hot property on the Digit premises

Who likes to work on a Saturday? Even the AC does a 5-day week. Beyond 6:30 pm, not a cubic metre of air is cooled. A mechanical relic called a fan tries to pacify our heated bodies, not to mention boiling tempers. As a result, all the writers here try all possible ways of scuttling away on time and disappearing on weekends. But then the copy desk hates to be left alone and their “you-better-be-there-or-I’ll-hack-your-article” look more often than not works in procuring the much-needed company.

But amidst all this grumbling and bickering, we did stand united over one thing: fans. They were so few, at times they would all disappear! Well, so we decided that we needed to get some... well, steal some.

We first stole right under the noses of people, only to be reprimanded and come back glum-faced. Then we got defensive. We work the most, we do this we do that blah blah blah... didn't work. How would it? After all, those guys, too, had cancelled their dates for a Saturday and were boiling in silence! A few sweaty days of introspection later, we were at it again. Well, the need of the hour was survival and that needed a fan. Ethics be damned. And so we went on rampaging mercilessly, and quite breathlessly as well.

We didn't spare a single bay. All of them were ransacked in the spirit of Menelaus seeking out Helen of Troy. Barbarians would have worshipped us had they only seen our undaunting persuasion. We didn't even spare the *bhaigiri*-doing Test Centre.

“Yeh apun ka fan hai kya?”

Oh yes, it is your fan.

“Lene ka nahi, samjha na...”

Whoever thought of doing that... er, at least when they are around. The moment they're out, their fans ARE ours. After all, if they aren't submitting articles on time, they'd better make this concession!



Mahesh Benkar

Recently, we got Mount Vesuvius to erupt violently when we raided TypeI—the content services division. And what a raid that was! We never knew such sleek fans existed just next door. We fanned ourselves royally for a week. Mitali oohed and aahed about it and Garfield almost killed her with his “How-dare-you-keep-it-all-to-yourself” look when the secret was leaked, and the TypeI guys raided us like a pack of FBI agents.

“Oh look, it's ours.”

“And how do you know that?”

“See this red tape, I put it here.”

But Prashant Narekuli, the Digit brand manager, would just not give in: “So what, *naam thodi likha hai. Aise kaise tum log aake fan le ja sakte ho*” and topped it with an arm-twisting look.

The ‘FBI’ agents were far from impressed. The fans did get smuggled back into TypeI, the terrifying look notwithstanding. This was just too much to digest.

“Let's shift into the garden” exploded one of the Digsters, “à la Shantiniketan.”

“Oh yeah,” cooed in a colleague,

“that way we won't even miss the latest gossip!”

“That would be great. Perhaps we could start an inhouse mag with all that stuff!”

Now, much as we like to make an issue about everything, Louis D'Mello, Head of Publications and Web sites, JDM, always tackles it all with some resourceful thinking. Perhaps it was this, or perhaps he was a bit wary of his own fan disappearing, Louis did the best thing he could do—within the next few weeks, tall, lissome, translucent fan stands began dotting the Digit bay. While Aparna and Meera helped assemble “their” own fan, the boys were a bit more generous and set it up for the entire team. Since then, the Sun has not been cursed and the swish of a button is all that's needed to drive the heat away.

Of course, we miss the fan-hunt (“Geez, it was so much fun!”). Of course, we miss the planning and strategy that went behind each of them (“Aaj TC, kal NC!”), but what we don't miss are the sweaty palms and the discomfort.

The heated arguments continue. ■